Positive Conservative Frame for Disengaged Voters

Optional companion document

Optional companion document. This companion document equips volunteers to shift disengaged Republicans and independents toward a positive, conservative perspective grounded in the 10 Commandments, the U.S. Constitution, and the Bill of Rights. It draws on ideas from the Heritage Foundation and Hillsdale College online courses. It is optional and secondary to the listen-first local model. Use it primarily in Republican club or ground-network settings after the other person opens the door on parties, values, or the next election. Always return to one local next step and the “We are the they” close. Frame remains: Return to the original social media — neighbors talking to neighbors. Match the ask to the setting.

Positive Foundation

The 10 Commandments and natural law supply the moral baseline the Founders assumed. The Constitution and Bill of Rights secure ordered liberty: limited government, individual rights, consent of the governed, separation of powers, and federalism. Heritage’s True North principles and Hillsdale’s Constitution 101 emphasize that government exists to protect life, liberty, and property; free enterprise and strong families drive prosperity; and the Constitution’s original meaning matters. One practical bridge: “These are the ideas that built the freest and most prosperous country in history. Which of them still matter most to your family?”

Clear Contrasts

- The DSA national program (program.dsausa.org) calls for steps toward fully abolishing the police and prison system, abolishing the Senate, abolishing ICE, legalizing migration with amnesty for all immigrants, public ownership of the largest corporations and essential industries, and replacing the President and Supreme Court with an executive and judiciary chosen by and subordinate to Congress. These conflict with the Constitution’s design.
- Islamist governance models prioritize religious law over individual rights and equal protection under the Constitution.
- National coverage, including outlets such as CNN, MSNBC (MS NOW), ABC, CBS, and the Washington Post, doesn’t always match what families see at home or what the primary data shows on inflation, the border, and crime. Return to lived household results and primary sources.

Lesser-of-Two-Evils Bridge

Use only after the other person raises “both sides are the same” or refuses to choose. Drawing on the practical distinction between a fallen candidate and an evil candidate: “No candidate is perfect. The practical question is whether we are choosing a fallen person whose policies still protect the family and the Constitution, or someone whose policies lead whole communities into greater harm.” Fallen candidate: personal failings. Evil candidate (policy sense): actively advances outcomes that undermine ordered liberty, border security, or parental rights at scale. Close back to one local action.

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Short Bridge

Use this after you've listened and let them know you heard them. It's one or two sentences that move the talk from the national noise to something local they care about, and it ends with a question so they keep talking. If they open up, keep listening. If not, thank them and move on.

"The Constitution and the ideas behind it still protect families better than the alternatives. Which of those protections still matter most to you?"

The Issue and Expanded Bridge

The facts behind the issue and a longer bridge, for when they want to keep talking.

The issue

Disengaged Republicans and independents often hear that both parties are the same or that national politics no longer matter. A positive conservative frame rooted in the Constitution, ordered liberty, and family results offers a clearer alternative than the DSA platform or Islamist models.

Short background

The Founders designed a limited government to protect God-given rights. Heritage and Hillsdale resources show how progressivism and modern socialism have moved away from that design. DSA proposals to abolish core institutions and Islamist prioritization of religious law over equal rights stand in direct contrast. National media framing doesn't always match the primary data on household costs and border numbers, so check the original sources.

The bridge

"I hear the frustration. On the things that protect your family — costs, safety, schools, the border — the Constitution still gives us the best tools. Which of those is weighing on you most right now?" Listen, then offer one local next step. When appropriate: "No candidate is perfect. The practical choice is between a fallen person whose policies still protect ordered liberty and someone whose policies lead communities into greater harm." *Close when it fits: "We are the they. Who's the next neighbor, the next person, you'll talk to?"*

Deeper Background

For your own preparation. You don't need to recite this. It helps you understand why people feel this way and answer questions with confidence.

Supporting frame

- 10 Commandments and natural law as the moral foundation assumed by the Founders.
- Constitution and Bill of Rights: limited government, individual rights, consent of the governed, separation of powers, federalism.
- Heritage True North principles and Hillsdale Constitution 101: original meaning, free enterprise, strong families, protection of life, liberty, and property.

Contrasts

- DSA program: abolish police/prisons, abolish the Senate, abolish ICE, legalize migration/amnesty, public ownership of the largest corporations, executive and courts subordinate to Congress.
- Islamist models: religious law over individual rights and equal protection.
- National media: coverage doesn't always match primary data on inflation, border, and crime. Check the source.

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The perspective shift

Local turnout still decides who protects or erodes these foundations. Precinct coverage, registration, and neighbors covering neighbors remain the practical path. The lesser-of-two-evils distinction is used only when the other person raises refusal to choose.

2-Minute Two-Person Conversation

A sample conversation from start to finish. Practice it with a partner until it sounds like you.

Setting: Front porch or sidewalk. Neighbor has just said both parties are the same or that voting doesn't matter.

Neighbor: Honestly, both sides are the same. I'm not sure any of it matters anymore.
You: I hear that a lot. What's hit your family the hardest lately — groceries, safety, schools, or something else?
Neighbor: Groceries and the border. And I'm tired of the media telling me what to think.
You: Yeah. The Constitution and the ideas behind it still protect families better than the alternatives. Groups like the DSA want to abolish the police, the Senate, and ICE. That is not the same as limited government under the Constitution. And the national news doesn't always match what people see at the store.
Neighbor: But every candidate has problems. Why choose?
You: No candidate is perfect. The practical question is whether we choose a fallen person whose policies still protect the family and the Constitution, or someone whose policies lead whole communities into greater harm. Local turnout is what decides that here.
Neighbor: I'm not sure I want to get involved.
You: No pressure. Would you be willing to check one neighbor's registration or talk with the next neighbor this month? I'll follow up. We are the they. What's one person you'd feel comfortable talking to?

How to Use This Frame

- Treat this document as optional and setting-sensitive. Republican club rooms can go deeper; pure civic settings stay nonpartisan and local.
- Start with the listen-first local conversation. Use this frame only after the other person opens the door on parties, values, or the next election.
- Always close back to one local commitment and the "We are the they" frame.
- Match the ask to the setting. Use the lesser-of-two-evils distinction only when the other person raises refusal to choose.

Neighbors talking to neighbors. We are the they.

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